

CRICKET VICTORIA

Extreme Conditions Policy



Overview

The purpose of this policy is to protect the health of those participating in **BOX HILL REPORTER DISTRICT CRICKET ASSOCIATION (BHRDCA)** matches from the potentially ill effects of extreme weather, while ensuring that play is not unnecessarily interrupted.

Scope

This policy applies to all matches in **BHRDCA** competitions.

Policy

If there is an adverse weather forecast (wet weather or extreme heat) for a scheduled Match:

In Advance

- By monitoring the Bureau of Meteorology 7-day temperature forecasts and seeking to maximise opportunities for play during times of extreme heat, **BHRDCA** has the power to reschedule the start of play to 10.00am in any match, to maximise the opportunity for play during a cooler time of the day.
- BHRDCA** may also consider cancellation of competitions in grades outside the Shield, T20 & U18 competitions of fixtured matches and where possible will seek necessary guidance from the Bureau of Meteorology and/or qualified practitioners.
- BHRDCA** will provide affected clubs with prior notice of any amendment to the playing time or potential cancellation. Clubs will be notified via email to the Administration contracts, the **BHRDCA** website and social media channels.

Match Day Morning

- BHRDCA** will consult ground reports and all available forecast data has been collated **BHRDCA's** decision will be communicated via email, text message to Administration contacts, the **BHRDCA** website and social media channels.

Match Day

- If the **BHRDCA** decision is "report to grounds", decisions regarding play will be determined by the Umpires in accordance with this policy.

EXTREME HEAT

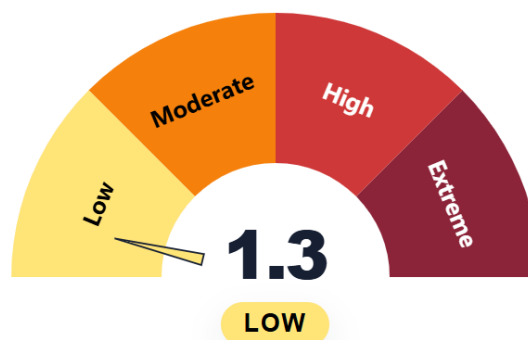
The Sport Medicine Australia (SMA) Extreme Heat Policy Tool (<https://sma-heat-policy.sydney.edu.au/>) is to be the standard and the measurement which is to be applied to following Shield Grades & Umpired Competitions for the purposes of this policy.

- Ray McIntosh Shield
- Dorothy McIntosh Shield
- Howard Wilson Shield
- Peter White Shield
- Under 18
- Senior T20

The SMA website displays a Heat Stress Risk based on Sports Medicine Australia's assessment for heat stress specifically for cricket based on the current weather observations for a specific location.

The SMA website will display the current Heat Stress Risk rating as well as providing a forecast for the remainder of the day. There are four Heat Stress Risk levels:

- Low (Yellow)
- Moderate (Orange)
- High (Red)
- Extreme (Dark Red)



These competitions have appointed umpires. In all cases:

- Umpires will have access to the required technology (smartphone/BOM app/HSRI tool)*
- The home club will support umpires where needed, ensuring internet access and assistance if an umpire's device is unavailable.

Additional drinks breaks and extended intervals

- a) Prior to the commencement of play for days with a predicted Heat Stress Risk of Moderate, the Umpires and captains shall conduct a heat safety briefing to determine whether to increase the number of drinks breaks.
- b) Prior to the commencement of play for days with a predicted Heat Stress Risk of High and Extreme, the Umpires and captains shall conduct a heat safety briefing to determine the number and duration of drinks intervals, unrestricted drinks around the boundary for bowlers and at the fall of a wicket, allowing Players and Umpires to leave the field of play during drinks breaks, and to determine whether to extend the duration of innings break and/or afternoon tea intervals. Additionally, Penalty Time for bowlers and batters will be discounted by 50% for any player who leaves the field to avoid or manage heat-related illness or injury.

Cessation, resumption and abandonment of play

It shall be the responsibility of each Club Manager (or their nominee) to monitor, on a half-hourly basis, the SMA Extreme Heat Policy Tool (<https://sma-heat-policy.sydney.edu.au/>). The suburb in which the match is being played should be used as the location to check the current rating.

- a) Suspension of Play: In the event of the Heat Stress Scale reaching the 'Extreme' level, the Umpires shall immediately suspend play.
- b) Resumption of Play: Following the suspension of play in (a) above, play shall not resume for a minimum of 30 minutes. If following the minimum 30-minute suspension, the Heat Stress Scale decreases to the level of 'High' or lower, play may recommence.
- c) Abandonment of Play: The Umpires, in consultation with the captains, may abandon the day's play immediately following a suspension, if the SMA Extreme Heat Policy Tool forecasted risk does not show a fall in the Heat Stress Scale from Extreme to High Level (or lower) by the scheduled close of play. In other words, there

may be no requirement to wait until the close of play before a decision is made to abandon the day's play.

There shall be no discretion to allow a resumption of that day's play once play has been abandoned due to extreme heat.

Player and Umpire Health and Welfare

Notwithstanding the above, the Umpires shall have the sole discretion to abandon play if they consider that, to continue play during prolonged or excessive heat, it would be dangerous to the health and welfare of any, or all, of the participants. To assist the Umpires in exercising their discretion, they may –

- a) consider any apparent signs of heat stress being displayed by any of the participants; and
- b) refer to an air temperature thermometer, if properly installed in the shade at the match venue.

No person is forced by **BHRDCA** to participate in any Match and Clubs shall place no pressure on any participant if they consider withdrawing from any part of a Match for health reasons.

All other grades outside the Shield, T20 & U18 competitions are recommended to follow the current policy standards

Senior Non-Shield Grades

The Extreme Conditions Policy will be activated when the Melbourne forecast from the Bureau of Meteorology (BoM) predicts a temperature of 37°C or higher during normal playing hours (1:00 pm – 6:00 pm).

Junior Grades

The policy applies when the forecast for Melbourne reaches 38°C or higher during:

- Twilight matches: 5:00 pm – 8:15 pm
- Morning matches: 8:30 am – 11:45 am

Veteran Grades

The policy applies when the forecast reaches 38°C or higher during normal playing hours (1:00 pm – 6:00 pm).

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Decision Times

The BHRDCA CoM will decide whether to cancel play by:

- 7:00 am for Saturday/Sunday morning junior matches
- 10:00 am for Saturday/Sunday afternoon senior or veterans matches
- 2:00 pm for junior twilight matches

If the policy is activated, the BHRDCA will notify clubs via:

- The BHRDCA website
- BHRDCA social media channels

Heat Management During Play

Drinks

- Umpires, captains, team managers, and coaches may allow extra drinks breaks at any time.
- Any player may request a drink break while batting, fielding, or umpiring.
- Bowlers may keep drinks on the boundary and drink at the end of an over.
- When the temperature exceeds 34°C, at least two drinks breaks per session are recommended.

Tea Break

- Umpires, captains, and junior team officials may extend the tea break due to heat.
- Lost time may be made up after the scheduled stumps time.
- All parties must agree on the change.

Player Rotation

- Any player feeling heat-affected may leave the field after notifying their captain and the umpire (if present).
- Teams with more than 11 players may rotate fielders to rest players.

- Umpires and captains should monitor juniors who have already played earlier in the day for signs of heat stress.

Heat Stress

- Any player showing signs of heat stress must be removed from the field immediately by the umpire, captain, or team official.

Shade & Sun Protection

- Clubs must provide shaded areas for batting teams, scorers, and spectators.
- Players should apply sunscreen frequently, wear long sleeves, and use hats (wide-brim recommended).

Umpires

- Umpires may take a break if they feel their health or judgment is affected by extreme conditions.
- They must arrange a suitable replacement before leaving the field.

First Aid

- Club first aid kits must include supplies for treating heat-affected players.
- Clubs should aim to have someone trained in heat-illness treatment at home games.
- A clear notice explaining heat-illness treatment must be displayed near the first aid kit.

Early Finish (Senior & Veterans)

- If extreme conditions exist, both captains may agree to end the match early once a first-innings result has been achieved.
- Both captains must agree for the match to finish early.

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LIGHTNING

In the event of a thunderstorm, the '30/30 rule' should be used to determine whether play should be suspended and when it is safe to resume.

Sound travels at a speed of around 1km every 3 seconds. When lightning is sighted, count the seconds between the flash of lightning and the sound of the thunder. If the time between flash and bang is less than 30 seconds, this means the storm is within 10km and is therefore close enough to be dangerous.

Umpires are to follow the following protocol where thunderstorms and lightning are present during play:

- (a) If thunder follows a lightning flash by between 30 - 40 seconds, play must cease immediately. Players and Umpires must leave the field but may cover the wicket and make necessary preparations for the thunderstorm.
- (b) If thunder follows a lightning flash within 30 seconds, then play must be suspended, Players and Umpires must leave the field immediately and must not return for a minimum of 30 minutes after the suspension commences.
- (c) Umpires are to monitor lightning / thunder patterns for a minimum of 30 minutes after play has been suspended, and only once a 30-minute period has passed without thunder/lightning, or the time between the lightning and thunder is more than 40 seconds, then play can resume.
- (d) Umpires will reinspect as often as appropriate and shall advise both captains of resumption times when agreed upon.

BHRDCA EXTREME CONDITIONS GUIDELINES

Competition Rule # provides prime guidance for the management of conditions during **BHRDCA** Matches. While Rule # is generally considered to relate to the fitness of the ground, weather and light for play to continue, it equally applies to extremes of conditions such as heat, cold, wind and lightning which may make continuation of play dangerous.

Rule # charges the Umpires with the responsibility to manage conditions and as such they are the final arbiters as to the fitness of conditions to allow play to continue.

When a period of extreme temperature is forecast, the following issues need to be considered by all participants when dealing with the heat:

- the conditions at each venue are to be assessed on a case-by-case basis;
- Umpires and Clubs are encouraged to 'manage' the availability of the extra 30 minutes of playing time available;
- where possible, unrestricted interchange of substitute fielders shall be permitted; and
- Umpires are to ensure that all time delays associated with implementing heat mitigation measures are recorded as allowances when calculating over rates for the purpose of determining penalty overs (i.e. "On-Field Delays Allowance" is to be adjusted accordingly).

Umpires are required to do all things within their power to facilitate play without compromising their responsibility in respect to "duty of care". They are therefore required to balance all the factors and decide whether the conditions are fit for play and, if not satisfied that they are safe, suspend play until such time as they are. Any such decision by the Umpires in relation to extremes of temperature would be supported should it occur.

Policy Statement

All persons named in this policy are required to comply with this policy, including any amendments made from time to time to ensure that business needs are met. Any changes will be communicated as far in advance as possible of the change being made.

Policy Implementation

Policy effective date: 1/10/2026

Policy review due: 1/10/2027

Policy approved by: Beau Nixon

